

A Logo for Narayanpal

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Abstract—This paper determines the parameter pairs (a, b) for the function $f(t) = e^{-at}u(t) + e^{bt}u(-t)$, subject to normalization, such that these pairs correspond to the endpoints of the latus recta of an associated conic. The work derives the conic equation binding the parameters, applies eigen-decomposition, and uses affine transformations to identify the valid (a, b) values. Additionally, a numerical gradient descent method is proposed to determine symmetric truncation points $\theta = (\theta_0, \theta_1)$ such that the areas under $f(t)$ on either side of $t = 0$ are equal. This approach allows for a flexible choice of the truncation window.

By comparison:

$$\mathbf{V} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{2} & 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (10)$$

$$\mathbf{u} = \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{1}{2} \\ -\frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix} \quad (11)$$

$$f = 0 \quad (12)$$

We eigen-decompose $\mathbf{V}$ as

$$\mathbf{V} = \mathbf{PDP}^T \quad (13)$$

$$\mathbf{P} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & \frac{-1}{\sqrt{2}} \\ \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \end{pmatrix} \quad (14)$$

$$\mathbf{D} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & 0 \\ 0 & \frac{-1}{2} \end{pmatrix} \quad (15)$$

Convert the conic into a standard conic using affine transformations.

$$\mathbf{y}^T \left(\frac{\mathbf{D}}{f_0} \right) \mathbf{y} = 1 \quad (16)$$

$$\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{Py} + \mathbf{c} \quad (17)$$

Where

$$f_0 = \mathbf{u}^T \mathbf{V}^{-1} \mathbf{u} - f = 1 \quad (18)$$

$$\mathbf{c} = -\mathbf{V}^{-1} \mathbf{u} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (19)$$

The eigenvalues of $\mathbf{D}$ are $\lambda_1 = \frac{1}{2}$, $\lambda_2 = -\frac{1}{2}$. Using a reflection matrix and further transformation, we get the hyperbola in standard form:

$$\mathbf{z}^T \left(\frac{\mathbf{D}_0}{f_0} \right) \mathbf{z} = 1 \quad (20)$$

$$j(\mathbf{z}) = \mathbf{z}^T \mathbf{D}_0 \mathbf{z} - f_0 = 0 \quad (21)$$

$$\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{P}_0 \mathbf{z} \quad (22)$$

Here $\mathbf{P}_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$ and $\mathbf{D}_0 = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{-1}{2} & 0 \\ 0 & \frac{1}{2} \end{pmatrix}$.

1. QUESTION

Given that

$$f(t) = e^{-at}u(t) + e^{bt}u(-t) \quad (1)$$

$$u(t) = \begin{cases} 0, & t < 0 \\ \frac{1}{2}, & t = 0 \\ 1, & t > 0 \end{cases} \quad (2)$$

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(t) dt = 1 \quad (3)$$

Find the possible values of (a, b) if these are the end points of the latus recta of the associated conic. Plot $f(t)$ for these values of (a, b) .

2. SOLUTION

We expand the integral as

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(t) dt = \int_{-\infty}^0 f(t) dt + \int_0^{\infty} f(t) dt \quad (4)$$

$$= \int_{-\infty}^0 e^{bt} dt + \int_0^{\infty} e^{-at} dt \quad (5)$$

$$= \frac{1}{b} + \frac{1}{a} \quad (6)$$

Substituting (3) in (6):

$$\frac{1}{a} + \frac{1}{b} = 1 \quad (7)$$

$$ab - a - b = 0 \quad (8)$$

This is the equation of a conic. If we take a as x and b as y and express this as a conic in standard form, we get

$$\mathbf{g}(\mathbf{x}) = \mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{V} \mathbf{x} + 2\mathbf{u}^T \mathbf{x} + f \quad (9)$$

Now, solve for the endpoints of the latus recta:

$$\mathbf{n} = \sqrt{\lambda_2} \mathbf{p}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \end{pmatrix} \quad (23)$$

$$e = \sqrt{2} \quad (24)$$

$$c = \pm \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \quad (25)$$

$$\mathbf{F} = \pm 2\mathbf{e}_2 \quad (26)$$

Equation of latus recta:

$$\mathbf{n}^T \mathbf{x} = \mathbf{n}^T \mathbf{F} \quad (27)$$

$$\equiv \mathbf{x} = \mathbf{h} + k\mathbf{m} \quad (28)$$

$$\mathbf{h} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ \pm 2 \end{pmatrix} \quad (29)$$

$$\mathbf{m} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (30)$$

Let $\hat{\mathbf{z}}$ be the endpoints of the latus recta:

$$k = \pm \sqrt{2} \quad (31)$$

$$\therefore \hat{\mathbf{z}} = \begin{pmatrix} \pm \sqrt{2} \\ \pm 2 \end{pmatrix} \quad (32)$$

Transforming back to the original conic:

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}} = \mathbf{P}(\mathbf{P}_0 \hat{\mathbf{z}}) + \mathbf{c} \quad (33)$$

Which gives:

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}}_1 = \begin{pmatrix} 2 + \sqrt{2} \\ \sqrt{2} \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}}_2 = \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{2} \\ 2 + \sqrt{2} \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}}_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 2 - \sqrt{2} \\ -\sqrt{2} \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}}_4 = \begin{pmatrix} -\sqrt{2} \\ 2 - \sqrt{2} \end{pmatrix}$$

Only $\hat{\mathbf{x}}_1$ and $\hat{\mathbf{x}}_2$ are valid as negative a or b will not yield a finite $f(t)$.

3. PLOTS

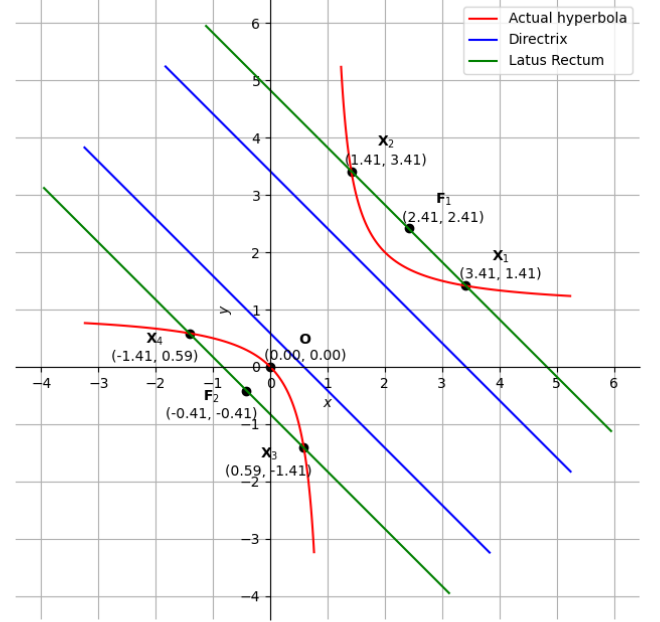


Fig. 1: Curve for valid values of a and b

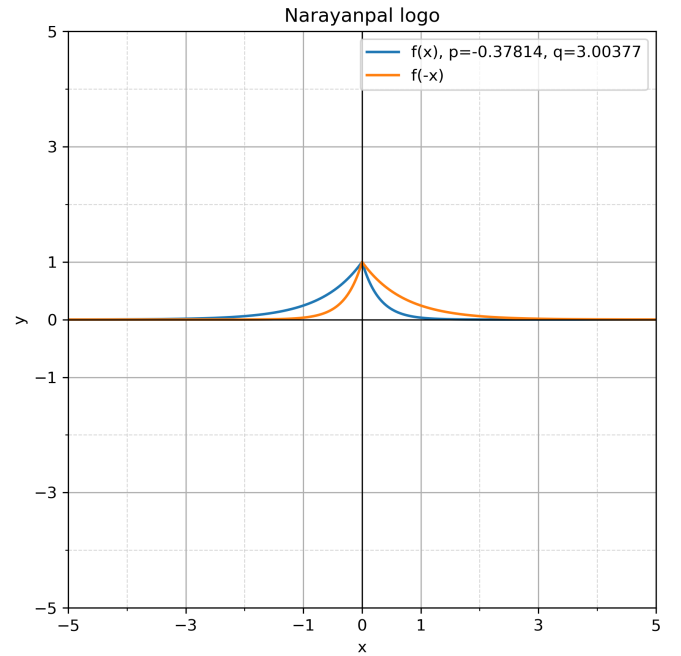


Fig. 2: Function $f(t)$ for valid (a, b)

4. NUMERICAL AREA BALANCING AND GRADIENT DESCENT

We need to find the endpoints (θ_0, θ_1) and truncate the function $f(t)$, such that the the area under $f(t)$ is symmetric about $t = 0$. For this, we will use gradient descent so that we get the closest solution to our guess.

Define:

$$A_L(\theta_0) = \int_{\theta_0}^0 e^{bt} dt = \frac{1 - e^{b\theta_0}}{b} \quad (34)$$

$$A_R(\theta_1) = \int_0^{\theta_1} e^{-at} dt = \frac{1 - e^{-a\theta_1}}{a} \quad (35)$$

We seek $\theta = (\theta_0, \theta_1)$ such that $A_L(\theta_0) = A_R(\theta_1)$. Rearranging:

$$\frac{1 - e^{b\theta_0}}{b} - \frac{1 - e^{-a\theta_1}}{a} = 0 \quad (36)$$

This nonlinear equation cannot be solved analytically in closed form. Thus, we define a cost function:

$$C(\theta) = \left(\frac{1 - e^{b\theta_0}}{b} - \frac{1 - e^{-a\theta_1}}{a} \right)^2 \quad (37)$$

We minimize this cost using gradient descent:

$$\frac{dC}{d\theta_0} = - \left(\frac{1 - e^{b\theta_0}}{b} - \frac{1 - e^{-a\theta_1}}{a} \right) e^{b\theta_0} \quad (38)$$

$$\frac{dC}{d\theta_1} = - \left(\frac{1 - e^{b\theta_0}}{b} - \frac{1 - e^{-a\theta_1}}{a} \right) e^{-a\theta_1} \quad (39)$$

The update rule becomes:

$$\theta_{n+1} \leftarrow \theta_n - \eta \cdot \nabla C(\theta_n) \quad (40)$$

where η is a learning rate.

We initialize θ with a reasonable estimate and iterate until $|C(\theta)| < 10^{-10}$. The resulting θ yields a numerically balanced integral under $f(t)$ on both sides of the origin.

$$\theta_{(0)} = [-2, 3]^T \rightarrow \theta_n = [-0.37815999, 3.00038288]^T \quad (41)$$

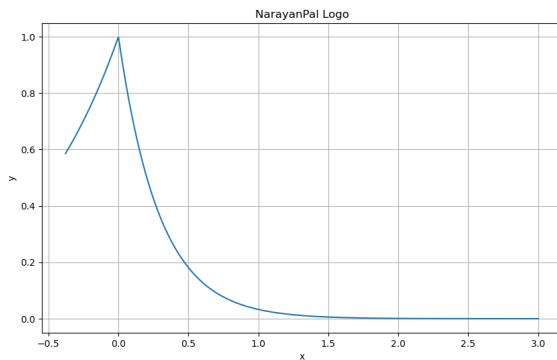


Fig. 3: Truncated Function $f(t)$

Refrences :

i)Convex Optimization by Stephen Boyd and Lieven Vandenberghe